

# National Reconstruction Authority(NRA) CEO Visit, Gorkha

Orientation and Interaction between newly elected officials and NRA  
organized by NRA district coordination secretariat Gorkha.

and

Meeting between HRRP partners and NRA.

2<sup>nd</sup> June, 2017

|                     |                                    |
|---------------------|------------------------------------|
| Activity Date:      | 02/06/2017                         |
| Report Prepared By: | Minar Thapa Magar, Keshab Shrestha |

## Discussion:

*NRA district coordination secretariat Gorkha organized one day orientation and interaction between newly elected local officials and NRA central team which is followed by NRA central team field visit and NRA executive member Hari ram Parajuli short meeting with reconstruction partners to discuss about current priorities and issues.*

*NRA CEO Dr. Govind Raj Pokharel, NRA executive member Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, NRA Joint secretary Mr. Yam lal Bhusal and team visited Palungtar municipality and met with newly elected mayor Mr. Deepak Kadel.*

*Orientation and interaction program was chaired by CDO Mr. Jitendra Basnet and NRA CEO Dr. Govind Raj Pokharel attended as chief guest, NRA central team as special guest and newly elected local officials, various government line agencies chief, press, representative of political parties, I/NGOs representatives etc. attended as participants.*

- **Presentation on Overall status of Gorkha district and Progress update ([Click here](#))**
  - Mr. Hom Nath Paudel, Chief district officer and Mr. Roshan Shrestha Chief, DUDBC Gorkha presented progress and current reconstruction status of Gorkha district.
  - 58503 HHs were enrolled, 54401 HHs have received 1<sup>st</sup> tranche, 7152 HHs have started reconstruction, 5307 HHs had constructed up to plinth level, 3156 HHs had been recommended for 2<sup>nd</sup> tranche, 49 HHs had been recommended for 3<sup>rd</sup> tranche whereas 991 HHs were not compliance to minimum requirements.
  - 16683 grievances were registered; 15008 grievances were handled and 2484 were declared as eligible beneficiaries.
  - 132HHs of Baguwa VDC were recommended to NRA for resettlement in integrated settlement by exchange of private land with forest land.
  - Only 87 out of 126 engineers, 34 out of 60 sub-engineers and 55 out of 60 sub-assistant sub engineers are remaining in Gorkha district. DLPIU chief requested NRA to prioritize filling up gaps in technical manpower for smooth and effective technical support and inspection process.
  - DUDBC chief Presented some of major non-compliance issues in RCC structures and masonry structures and updated that correction and exception of Non-compliance RC frame structure and reconstructed dry stone houses in northern VDCs are major challenges in Gorkha district.
  - Chief district engineer Mr. Hom Nath Paudel also presented overall challenges and issues or current reconstruction process.

### Discussion:

- **Presentation on NRA's vision towards dignified livelihood ([Click here](#))**
  - Mr. Bijaya Rana, Under Secretary, NRA presented National reconstruction authority's vision towards dignified livelihood through local empowerment.
- **Presentation on reconstruction after earthquake: experience sharing and future planning. ([Click here](#))**
  - Mr. Yam Lal Bhusal, Joint Secretary, NRA presented organizational structure of NRA, major policy and legal documents related with reconstruction, main working areas of NRA, development partners supporting reconstruction, major challenges and opportunities of the reconstruction campaign and actions to be taken immediately.

Mr. Rajendra Karki, Chief of Secretariat of the NRA District Coordination Committee, Gorkha facilitated an open space for interaction through questions and answer session.



| Issues (Q&A) session- Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, executive member, NRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Reference Document                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, executive member addressed questions and issues shared by participants. (Locally elected officials, press and participants)</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ HHs displaced in Budi Gandaki hydroelectric project inundation area will receive NPR 2 lakh as government subsidy for temporary house construction and guideline for temporary house will soon be released and displaced households can get earthquake subsidy of 3 lakhs if they do own or buy land in another place.</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ NRA appealed for additional top up of <u>Rs 50 thousand additional grant or technical support or both to assist disadvantages region and groups, single women, Dalits, elderly and differently able families</u> to private sectors, I/NGOs etc. to build earthquake resilience house in compliance with government standards.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                   | <p>NRA's Public appeal (<a href="#">Click Here</a>)</p>                                                                             |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ <u>Grievances</u> were addressed but there are still some issues and NRA requested support from newly elected local representatives to verify false and genuine earthquake victims and provide full support during re-survey or verification with no one left behind.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <p>Grievance Management Guidelines 2073 (<a href="#">Click Here</a>)<br/>Grievance handling report (<a href="#">Click Here</a>)</p> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>✓ Correction and exception manual published recently will allow some exception in minimum requirements but based on our seismic design building code 105. Now, engineers can provide correction measures during and after construction to make houses compliance with government standards.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                        | <p>Correction/Exception Manual (<a href="#">Click Here</a>)</p>                                                                     |

| Issues (Q&A) session- Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, executive member, NRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Reference Document                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ Guideline has developed policy for landless people and NRs 2 lakh will be provided as subsidy to buy land for identified potential land less people. Beneficiaries who do not have safe land for house construction after earthquake will also be supported by additional NRs 2 lakh NRs for buying land.                                   | NRA Website's news<br>( <a href="#">Click Here</a> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| ✓ NRA has just published the Procedures for interest-free loans based on collective guarantee, 2017 and in it 'disadvantaged groups are defined as those who have low income, are socially marginalized, small farmers, artisans, workers and landless people. NRA will soon release detailed working procedure with support from world bank. | Interest free loan<br>( <a href="#">Click Here</a> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| ✓ Geological study was already conducted in Gorkha district and 565 HHs in Kerauja needs to be relocated and NRA requested newly elected local representatives to recommend alternative place for relocation and another assessment will be done for resettlement.                                                                            | NRA Geo-Hazard Assessment Presentation<br>( <a href="#">Click Here</a> )<br>NRA Vulnerable settlement rehabilitation and relocation guideline.<br>( <a href="#">Click Here</a> )                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ✓ Chum-Nubre Rural municipality is quite challenge as construction typology is dry stone masonry and many houses were already built right after earthquake and now we need data of all houses and NRA will support to provide possible solutions for safe housing.                                                                            | Please Click link below for designs.<br>random rubble masonry ( <a href="#">architectural</a> , <a href="#">detail 2</a> , and <a href="#">detail 3</a> ), and dressed stone masonry ( <a href="#">architectural</a> , <a href="#">dressed stone masonry 1</a> , <a href="#">dressed stone masonry 2</a> , and <a href="#">dressed stone masonry 3</a> ). |

| Closing remarks by NRA CEO Dr. Govind Raj Pokha                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• NRA CEO Dr. Govind Raj Pokharel presented a video taken during his visit to Sirdivas VDC of Gorkha district and he briefed about importance and opportunities for social, economic and physical reconstruction.</li> <li>• He also emphasized importance of economic development through local empowerment for dignified livelihood along with reconstruction for sustainable development of communities and country.</li> <li>• He also briefed that engineers will be deployed under rural municipality and municipality after this fiscal year closing and locally elected representative will be directly involved in monitoring and supervision of DLPIU engineers. Local federal body can also provide addition wages, incentives and other support to engineers based on their capacities.</li> <li>• Concept of 'Reconstruction fund' could be very effective and NRA will fully support it so that local body can manage and take ownership of that fund and can utilize fund to support vulnerable beneficiaries at once and take back after receiving government subsidy. Many donors are also interested to support this bucket fund.</li> <li>• Small water schemes, programs and projects can be managed directly by rural municipalities and municipalities and NRA is very interested to coordinate directly with new administrative bodies for more responsibilities and their duties.</li> <li>• NRA requested newly elected officials to get involved and provide to support current reconstruction process to utilize gap time before this end of fiscal year.</li> </ul> |

#### **Closing remarks and suggestions by Mr. Jitendra Basnet, CDO, Gorkha**

- Mr. Jitendra Basnet, CDO of Gorkha thanked NRA CEO, central team and newly elected representatives for their visit to Gorkha for attending and supporting sharing, discussion and interaction program between government, newly elected local representatives and other stakeholders.
- CDO requested newly elected local representatives to prioritize reconstruction program as main agenda and recently cabinet of ministry released TOR for local federal body and their representatives. ([Click Here](#))
- Grievance should be addressed as fast as we can, two categories (Beneficiaries having 2 houses and safe land available to construct house in previous footprints) for resurvey and reverification will be a huge challenge. Some beneficiaries do have two houses one in city and one in rural village and their elderly parents are still living in village which should be considered.
- He requested NRA and DUDBC/DLPIU to reorient and send engineers to their working VDC to facilitate second tranche of installment as soon as possible because some of engineers did not accepted application of those houses which are not compliance. For third tranche, due to software problems third tranche cannot be released to HHs with government assistance. He requested NRA and relevant agencies to solve software problem.
- Geological assessment was already conducted for Kerauja, kashigaun, Lapu and Barpak VDCs and another level of assessment for identifying potential land for relocation needs to be speed up as beneficiaries from those areas have already received first tranche and waiting for government decisions and solutions.
- He appreciated progress on construction of school buildings and infrastructures and training through government and I/NGOs and shared experience during enrollment as Gorkha completed enrollment in all VDCs with support from partners and he requested all stakeholders to work from their part/side to make reconstruction smooth and effective also by making more houses compliance to government standards.
- He updated out of 200 corer NRs as housing grant only 55 corer NRs has been disbursed and he requested everyone to create enable environment for people to reconstruct and receive 2<sup>nd</sup> and 3<sup>rd</sup> tranche as much as we can.

#### **Key discussion points and decision made during coordination meeting between NRA and Partner organizations**

##### **-Chaired by Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, Executive member, NRA**

- Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli, executive member of NRA urged partners to prioritize construction of demo house and mason training and door to door assistance as beneficiaries already started to reconstruct their houses.
- Mr. Rajendra Karki, Chief of NRA Gorkha updated about monthly progress report submitted by various organizations and requested partners to support in regular monthly reporting as mentioned in I/NGO mobilization guideline. Central NRA requested HRRP to facilitate regular reporting mechanism to support NRA.
- Dr. Hari Ram Parajuli also requested HRRP to conduct orientation on correction and exception manual for partners and government within 10 days.
- He also requested partners to train non-local masons also in skilled and vocational training as they are more involve in reconstruction and plays major role.
- Partners emphasized on uniformity and dissemination of general and technical information to communities by government and partners.